

certified and others expected to launch in the near term. While acknowledging short-term market adjustments, she emphasises the long-term benefits. “The policy creates some near-term transition for the market, but over time it will strengthen compliant manufacturers, protect end users, and build a more secure domestic ecosystem,” she says.

She also points to the next phase of evolution, noting that stronger audits and more stringent supply-chain validation will further reinforce the framework.

Scale came easy; control did not

India’s surveillance expansion over the past decade was driven by scale and accessibility. Global manufacturers such as Hikvision and Dahua supplied affordable, feature-rich systems that made large-scale deployments viable.

Cities rapidly expanded camera networks, housing societies standardised installations, and businesses integrated surveillance into everyday operations.

The model worked efficiently from a cost and availability perspective, but it also created layered dependency. Hardware, firmware, and chipsets were often sourced from interconnected global supply chains, making it difficult to separate the product from its ecosystem.

Even Indian brands such as CP Plus scaled within this structure, building strong distribution networks and brand recognition while relying on external sourcing to meet demand. It was not a flaw in execution; it was simply how the market evolved.

However, as concerns about data control, cybersecurity, and supply-chain trust intensified, that model began to appear increasingly fragile.

Beyond the device

The next phase of regulatory and industry focus is likely to extend into lifecycle security, continuous validation, and deeper supply-chain transparency.

India’s CCTV reset represents a deeper shift in how surveillance is understood and managed in a connected world. What was once a matter of visibility is now a matter of control, trust, and accountability.

The future of surveillance lies not in watching more, but in understanding faster and responding smarter—a reality captured in *Little Brother*, where Cory Doctorow writes, “*You can’t defend. You can only detect and respond.*” **EFY**

Pratyush Kumar has a background in TV reporting and a keen interest in electronics, technology, emerging gadgets, and market trends.

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